Certificate in Financial Planning: Marketing majors

Advising one-pager · BBA in Marketing, 2026-27 catalog · Gatton College, November 2026

Scan: how to add it

Which sheet? Wealth management or financial planning: CFP. Investment research or portfolio management: CFA. Investment banking or private equity: Investment Banking. Real estate lending, investment, or development: Real Estate. Students can combine them. All sheets: willgerken.com/roadmaps

What it is

Financial planners help people manage money across investments, taxes, retirement, insurance, and estates. Personal financial advisors earned a **median of $105,070** in 2025, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics. The six courses satisfy the **education requirement** for CFP® certification; the exam, experience, and ethics requirements complete it. Open to any major, and full-time on-campus undergraduates add it in myGPS at **no additional tuition**. Each course needs a C or better. No business courses are needed first; only FIN 359 must come after the others.

The six courses

Area	Course	Offered	For a Marketing major
Fundamentals	**FIN 350*** (or ACC 356, if already taken)	Fall, spring	free elective
Tax	**ACC 357**, or **ACC 407**†	ACC 357: fall only. ACC 407: fall, spring	free elective
Investment	**FIN 357**	Fall, spring	free elective
Estate	**ACC 457**	Fall, spring	free elective
Retirement	**FIN 358**	Fall, spring; no alternate course	free elective
Capstone	**FIN 359**	Fall, spring; taken last	free elective

* FIN 350 lists a 60-credit-hour prerequisite that can be waived: email the director. ACC 457's tax prerequisite is waived for certificate students.

The posted four-year plan, with the certificate on top

Year	Fall	Spring
Freshman	CIS 110, MA 109, UK Core ×3	CIS 111, MA 123, UK Core ×3
Sophomore	AN 105, ACC 200, ECO 201, STA 296, MKT 300, elective	ECO 202, ACC 201, MGT 301, MA 162, elective
Junior	MKT 310, ECO 391, AN 300, **FIN 350***, **ACC 357**	CIS 300, FIN 300, MKT 340, MKT 300-level, **FIN 357**
Senior	MKT 300-level, MGT 340, **FIN 358**, **ACC 457**	MKT 450, MKT 300-level, **FIN 359**, elective ×2

Roadmap course **Counts for roadmap and major ✓** Major requirement UK Core, electives *Italic = recommended* One term only

The certificate takes **six of the plan's ten electives**, and four stay open. ACC 357 sits in junior fall, which has room, so it isn't left for the last fall.

Spring start, or three terms left? FIN 350, FIN 357 in spring; ACC 357, ACC 457, FIN 358 in fall; FIN 359 last. Expect a heavier term.

Three things to know

1. **It fits in the electives.** Six of ten, with four still open.
2. **Take ACC 357 in a fall.** It is the one course that runs in a single term, so a student who reaches senior spring without it cannot finish before graduating (Executive Education afterward costs $895 a course).
3. **Save FIN 359 for last.** It is the capstone and runs both terms. Once ACC 357 has its fall, the other courses can go in either term.

After the certificate

- Students can sit for the CFP exam as soon as their completion is reported. Experience (6,000 hours, or 4,000 through an apprenticeship) and the bachelor's degree can follow the exam.
- Licenses depend on the job: Series 65 or 66 for RIA roles; SIE, Series 7, and 63 or 66 for broker-dealers; state life and health for insurance. We **recommend the SIE** for every student: it needs no sponsoring firm and is not required for the CFP.
- Get involved: the Finance Society's Financial Planning Pathway.

To add the certificate: talk with an advisor, then myUK → myGPS → My Program of Study → Request a Major Change → Add a Major, and search for Financial Planning (adds the certificate, not a second major). Details: gatton.uky.edu/certificate-financial-planning, or scan the code at top.

Terms. Free elective: any course the student chooses that counts toward graduation hours. SIE: Securities Industry Essentials, FINRA's entry-level exam. † **ACC 407: Accounting majors and double majors only.** Other majors take ACC 357 (fall only).

Director: Will Gerken, CFP®, will.gerken@uky.edu · Plan: posted 2026-27 Marketing sample curriculum; the catalog year a student entered under governs.

A general guide, not official advising. Compiled from publicly posted UK catalog and curriculum pages; requirements change and no warranty is given. Confirm your plan with your academic advisor and your myUK GPS degree audit.